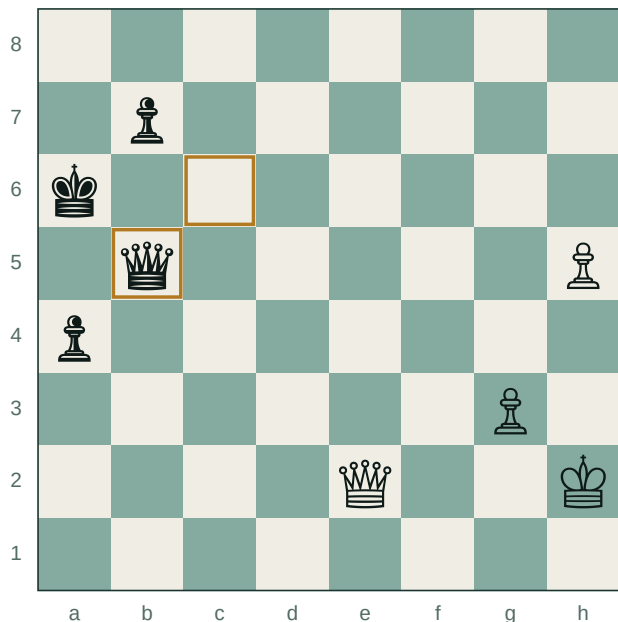


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 78

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 77...Qb5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

78. Qxb5+ Kxb5 79. h6 a3 80. h7

78.Qxb5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on b5. Recorded reply: **78...Kxb5**.

79.h6 The pawn moves from h5 to h6. Recorded reply: **79...a3**.

80.h7 The pawn moves from h6 to h7.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on a6. Absolute pin: queen on b5.